The SMART Study

INVITATION FOR SCHOOL LEADERS

Will your school help find out what's best for children and phones?

Nobody knows yet the best age for a first smartphone, or how best to set one up. The SMART Study will help find out, for the Department for Education. We're inviting around 80 primary schools in England, with their pupils in **Years 3 to 5**, from **September 2027** to **September 2028**.

Will your school take part?

Sign up by **[date]** at **[web address]**, or reply to this email. It takes about 5 minutes.

[QR code]

What taking part involves for your school

- **Summer term 2027** — Sign up and name a contact. Share our invitation with families in Years 3 to 5: we give you everything you need.
- **Autumn term 2027** — Pupils do the first of two short reading and maths assessments (in the PIRA and PUMA format many schools already use) in class, about **[45] minutes**. You fill in a short survey.
- **During the year** — Pass on our messages and posters to families now and then. No extra teaching.
- **Summer term 2028** — Pupils do the second assessment. You fill in a last short survey.

Two groups, chosen by chance. To make it a fair test, schools are split into two groups by chance. In one, families follow a simple plan until September 2028: if their child has no smartphone, they wait; if they have one, they set it up with a short list of apps. In the other, families carry on as usual. Every school does the same assessments and surveys.

What you get, whichever group you're in

[£X] for your school
A thank-you payment when the study ends.

Your pupils' results
Reading and maths scores from both assessments.

Resources for families
Motivational videos, comic books and a newsletter.

What we find
A summary of the findings, shared with you first.

Taking part is your school's choice, and you can stop at any time.

Questions? Email smartphonestudy@public.io, or call [phone number].

Run by IFF Research, PUBLIC and the University of Cambridge for the Department for Education.